

The re-scrape changed the answer

Your car is worth less than last week's estimate — not because the market moved, but because the old number rested on a coefficient that 3.7× more data does not support.

\$58,445

−\$7,058 (−10.8%) vs v1

Central estimate, BaT auction with reserve, August 2026

\$47,800 - \$71,400

68% likely hammer range. The model is *better* than v1 on every measure — 651 sales instead of 177, cross-validated error down from 14.5% to 12.6%, residuals flat across all mileage bands. The estimate fell because the data got more honest, not noisier.

n = 651

R² 0.807

CV err 12.6%

was n = 177

Where the \$7,058 went

Almost all of it is one coefficient. The rest of the model actually moved *in your favour*.



v1 estimated Cinnamon from 22 cars in a 27-month window. v2 has 55 spanning 12 years.

Two things I told you last week that were wrong

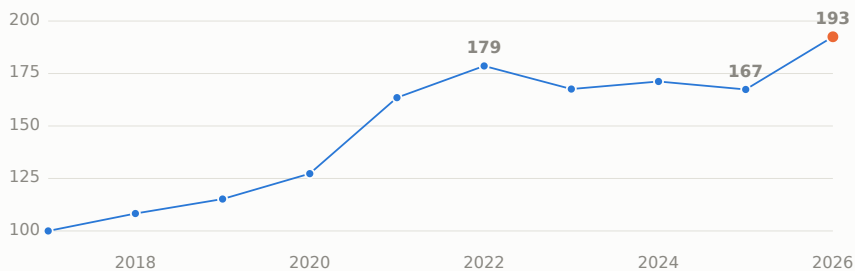
Cinnamon is +16.7%, not +35%. Still highly significant and still the single best thing about your car after the odometer — but roughly half what I quoted. A refit on the recent window alone still shows $\sim +31\%$, so a genuine re-rating is possible. I tested it: the interaction is not significant ($p=0.19$), and with only 13 Cinnamon cars before 2021 there isn't power to call it. The full-sample figure is the defensible one.

Slicktop is worth nothing measurable — -0.2% , $p=0.96$. I reported $+14.8\%$ and called it "a floor" that would rise once the data distinguished confirmed moonroofs from unknowns. It did the opposite: with 781 cars now positively confirmed as having moonroofs, the premium evaporated. The v1 figure was an artifact of comparing advertised slicktops against a contaminated everything-else group. Good news for you incidentally — your moonroof costs nothing.

The market itself is at an all-time high

Replacing the single trend line with year effects shows what a compounding curve was hiding: a sharp 2021–22 run, a three-year plateau, and a decisive 2026 breakout. **2026 is running about 15% above 2025** and is the strongest reading in the index.

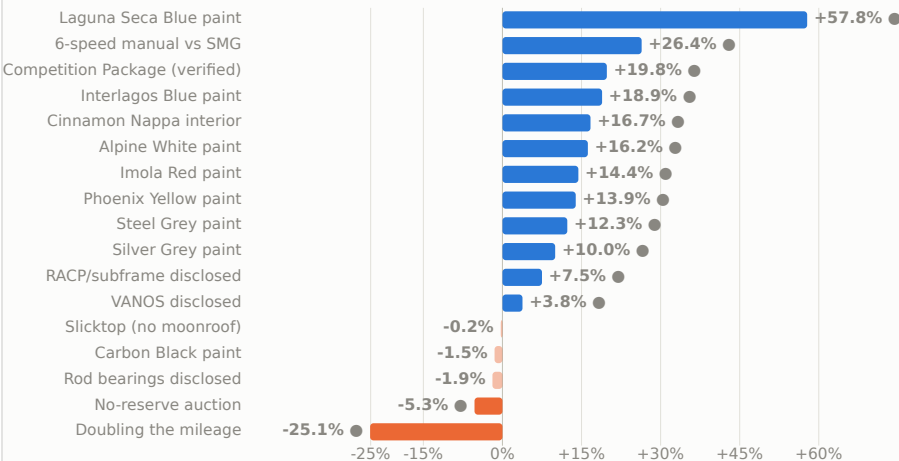
Quality-adjusted price index (2017 = 100)



Each point is the year's price level holding mileage, spec, colour and condition constant. AIC improves 65 points over the v1 constant-growth trend.

What drives price now

Effect on sale price, all else equal — n=651



● significant at $p < 0.05$. Reference car: Titanium Silver over Black, SMG, no ZCP, moonroof confirmed, reserve auction.

\$76,700

What your car would be worth
at 10,000 miles

+26.6%

Manual over SMG — unchanged
and rock solid

+57.6%

Laguna Seca Blue, still in a
class of its own

+15%

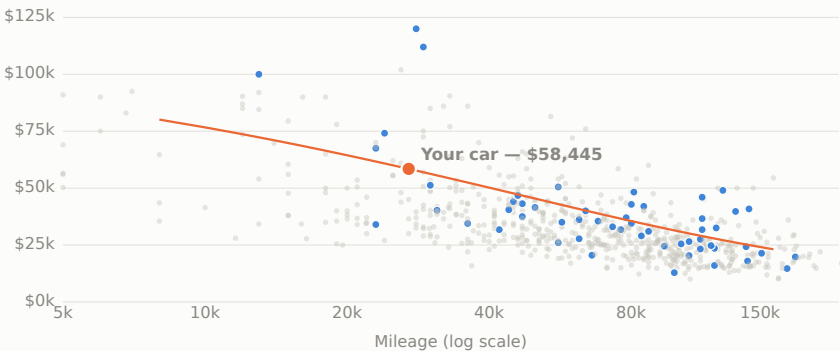
2026 market level vs 2025 —
new series high

The mileage curve, corrected

v1 forced a straight line through log-mileage. That overpredicted sub-25k cars by about 9% and underpredicted the 25–40k band by about 6% — and **your car sits in that underpredicted band**. A cubic spline flattens residuals to under $\pm 2\%$ everywhere and is worth about **+\$3,200** to your estimate.

Modelled value vs mileage — your spec, 2026 market

■ Cinnamon-interior sales ■ All other sales ■ Your car



Your comps

Low-mileage manual sales since January 2024, with what the model predicted for each. The scatter in the error column is the honest picture of auction variance — and the reason to read the range, not the point.

SALE	SOLD	VS MODEL	MILES	COLOUR / INTERIOR	DATE
6k-Mile 2004 6-Speed	\$90,000	+7%	6,000	Silver Grey / Imola Red	4/22/2026
6k-Mile 2005 6-Speed	\$75,000	+9%	6,000	Silver Grey / Black	5/15/2025
7k-Mile 2006 6-Speed	\$92,500	+39%	7,000	Jet Black / Black	6/6/2024
8k-Mile 2003 6-Speed	\$64,654	+6%	8,000	Carbon Black / Black	5/28/2024
12k-Mile 2002 6-Speed	\$87,000	+37%	12,000	Imola Red / Black	5/10/2024
12k-Mile 2006 ZCP 6-Speed	\$90,333	+29%	12,000	Carbon Black / Black · ZCP	12/17/2024
Original- Owner 2004 6-Speed	\$73,500	+4%	12,000	Alpine White / Black	4/5/2024
13k-Mile Slicktop 2002 6-Speed	\$84,500	+2%	13,000	Laguna Seca Blue / Grey	1/30/2025

SALE	SOLD	VS MODEL	MILES	COLOUR / INTERIOR	DATE
13k-Mile 2005 6-Speed	\$100,000	+35%	13,000	Alpine White / Cinnamon	12/10/2025
15k-Mile 2002 6-Speed	\$38,000	-24%	15,000	Titanium Silver / Black	5/17/2024
15k-Mile 2002 6-Speed	\$47,750	-5%	15,000	Titanium Silver / Black	2/7/2024
18k-Mile 2001 6-Speed	\$90,000	+14%	18,000	Laguna Seca Blue / Grey	1/9/2024
19k-Mile 2001 6-Speed	\$40,000	-30%	19,000	Imola Red / Black	4/27/2024
20k-Mile 2001 6-Speed	\$38,250	-28%	20,000	Imola Red / Black	11/25/2024
20k-Mile 2003 6-Speed	\$50,000	-11%	20,000	Mystic Blue / Grey	3/26/2024
23k-Mile 2006 6-Speed	\$67,500	-25%	23,000	Alpine White / Cinnamon · ZCP	2/25/2026
23k-Mile 2002 6-Speed	\$70,000	+25%	23,000	Imola Red / Imola Red	9/25/2024
Original- Owner, 24k-Mile 2002 6-Speed	\$74,125	+33%	24,000	Titanium Silver / Cinnamon	1/14/2025

SALE	SOLD	VS MODEL	MILES	COLOUR / INTERIOR	DATE
25k-Mile 2006 6-Speed	\$55,555	+6%	25,000	Imola Red / Grey	8/3/2025
26k-Mile 2003 6-Speed	\$61,000	+12%	26,000	Imola Red / Black	4/17/2024
26k-Mile 2004 6-Speed	\$102,000	+44%	26,000	Laguna Seca Blue / Black	10/24/2025
26k-Mile 2003 6-Speed	\$48,000	-10%	26,000	Imola Red / Imola Red	6/7/2024
★ YOUR CAR — 2004 M3 Coupe 6-Speed	\$58,445		27,000	Carbon Black / Cinnamon	est. Aug 2026
28k-Mile 2005 ZCP 6-Speed	\$120,000	+44%	28,000	Interlagos Blue / Cinnamon · ZCP	2/19/2026
28k-Mile 2005 6-Speed	\$37,000	-23%	28,000	Jet Black / Grey	9/25/2025
29k-Mile Slicktop 2006 6-Speed	\$75,069	+33%	29,000	Imola Red / Black	6/30/2026
29k-Mile 2004 6-Speed	\$112,000	+40%	29,000	Laguna Seca Blue / Cinnamon	5/24/2024
29k-Mile 2003 6-Speed	\$57,000	+16%	29,000	Imola Red / Black	7/5/2025

SALE	SOLD	VS MODEL	MILES	COLOUR / INTERIOR	DATE
30k-Mile 2006 ZCP 6-Speed	\$85,000	+37%	30,000	Interlagos Blue / Black · ZCP	9/27/2024
31k-Mile 2003 6- Speed	\$42,000	+4%	31,000	Titanium Silver / Grey	11/8/2024
33k-Mile 2005 ZCP 6-Speed	\$43,000	-26%	33,000	Interlagos Blue / Black · ZCP	9/28/2025
35k-Mile 2003 6- Speed	\$63,000	0%	35,000	Laguna Seca Blue / Grey	10/16/2024
35k-Mile 2003 6- Speed	\$43,750	-16%	35,000	Steel Grey / Black	4/12/2026
38k-Mile 2006 ZCP 6-Speed	\$70,000	+31%	38,000	Interlagos Blue / Black · ZCP	11/25/2024
39k-Mile 2003 6- Speed	\$42,000	-11%	39,000	Silver Grey / Grey	3/29/2026
41k-Mile 2003 6- Speed	\$39,000	+3%	41,000	Carbon Black / Black	9/18/2024
41k-Mile 2003 6- Speed	\$34,000	-19%	41,000	Silver Grey / Black	10/8/2024
2002 6- Speed	\$51,546	-8%	43,000	Laguna Seca Blue / Grey	4/16/2025
44k-Mile 2004 6- Speed	\$45,000	-17%	44,000	Titanium Silver / Black · ZCP	4/25/2026

What this means for you

SCENARIO	ESTIMATE
Conservative — soft night, thin bidder pool	\$47,800
Central — reserve auction, strong presentation	\$58,445
Strong — two motivated Cinnamon bidders	\$71,400
Complete VANOS before listing	\$60,671
Complete VANOS + RACP before listing	\$65,233
List at no reserve (still not recommended)	\$55,363

Hammer prices before BaT buyer's fee.

The pre-sale maintenance case weakened. VANOS is now worth **+\$2,200**, not the +\$7,800 v1 implied — that no longer clearly beats the cost of the job. RACP moved the other way: **+7.4% and now firmly significant** ($p<0.001$, up from $p=0.13$). If you do one thing before selling, the subframe is now the better-evidenced choice. Doing both is worth about \$6,800 combined.

Rod bearings still show no premium (-2.1% , $p=0.26$). The advice stands: get an inspection on record rather than paying for the full job.

What the re-scrape cost

The fixes were real — all five extraction bugs corrected, coverage up from 200 rows to 937, and I verified the three known-bad colours independently. Two things got worse, both unavoidable:

- **The accident penalty is gone.** BaT renders its Carfax panel in client-side JavaScript, so a bulk scrape can't see it — the column is now empty on all 937 rows. v1 measured a -16.8% accident discount; that's no longer estimable. It doesn't affect your valuation (your own Carfax PDF is clean and independent of this dataset), but it's a real loss to the model. Never read the empty column as "no accidents" — it means unknown.
- **Mileage is coarser.** Exact Carfax odometer readings came from the same widget, so 94% of mileages are now rounded to the nearest thousand, up from 87%. Minor, but it's the model's most important input.

Also worth knowing: 39 listings state no mileage anywhere and drop out of the fit; 109 sold cars have no interior colour and are carried as an explicit Unknown level rather than discarded.

Method

OLS on log sale price. $n=651$ BaT-sold non-modified E46 M3 coupes, 2014–2026, from the corrected 937-row file. Cubic spline ($df=4$) in log-mileage; year fixed effects; controls for transmission, verified Competition Package, paint, interior, disclosed rod-bearing / RACP / VANOS work, roof status and reserve. $R^2=0.807$, 5-fold cross-validated median absolute error 12.6%. All headline coefficients confirmed against a Huber robust re-fit with negligible movement. Modified, supercharged, swapped and track cars excluded. Mechanical-work fields remain seller free-text and are weak signals. Auction results carry irreducible variance from bidder composition, photography, timing and reserve strategy — the range is the answer, not the point estimate.